have written on the matter, including Fatemi, Oil Diplomacy and Ewalt, 'The Fight for Oil', History Today, Vol. 31 (1981), pp. 11–15.

45. TNA/FO371/6405/E9260, Memorandum by W.A. Smart, 21 June 1921. While the Soviet Republic that had been established in Gilan had been short-lived – ultimately disintegrating in late 1920 – the north of Persia remained the main base for the Persian Communist Party and generally where more revolutionaries of all ilk were to be found. Hence the British belief that this was now a 'Bolshevik' area. See White, 'Soviet Russia', pp. 223–5.

46. TNA/FO371/6401/E1985, Memorandum by Armitage-Smith, 14 Feb. 1921.

47. TNA/FO371/6400/E1226, Telegram from Curzon to Norman, 21 Jan. 1921.

48. TNA/FO371/6400/E1196, Telegram from Chelmsford to Montagu, 22 Jan. 1921.

49. Given that the Indian government was used to working with the various tribal leaders who controlled the south of Persia, it also did not have much sympathy for attempts to bolster what it saw as a weak Shah. That being said, this was not simply a matter of Delhi's preference for a decentralised Persia versus London's desire for centralisation. Instead, the argument centred on how far British interference in Persia should go, not where it should concentrate its attention.

50. TNA/FO371/6403/E4805, Telegram from Norman to the Foreign Office, 23 April 1921.

51. Debo, Survival , p. 370. Tapp, 'The Soviet–Persian Treaty of 1921', International Law Quarterly, Vol. 4 (1951), pp. 511–14 provides a brief look at some of the details of the treaty.

52. TNA/FO371/6399/E717, Telegram from Norman to the Foreign Office, 14 Jan. 1921.